

Question:

A baby is born after the 32nd gestational week by cesarean delivery. The mother suffered from gestational diabetes; however, she had no other pregnancy-related diseases and was otherwise healthy. The baby has a blood pressure of 100/58 mm Hg, heart rate of 104/min, and oxygen saturation of 88%. The child has tachypnea, subcostal and intercostal retractions, nasal flaring, and cyanosis. The cyanosis is responding well to initial administration of oxygen. The nasogastric tube was positioned without problems. Which of the following is the most likely diagnosis?

Answer Choices:

- A. Neonatal respiratory distress syndrome (NRDS)
- B. Tracheoesophageal fistula
- C. Pneumonia
- D. Congenital heart anomaly with right-to-left shunt

Reasoning + Answer:

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- The baby has tachypnea, retractions, and cyanosis, suggesting respiratory distress.

- Blood pressure and heart rate are within normal limits for a neonate.

- Nasogastric tube placement without issues suggests no structural obstruction like a fistula.

- The absence of other symptoms, such as fever or cough, and response to oxygen suggest NRDS over pneumonia or infection.

- However, the presence of cyanosis and respiratory distress could also be due to a congenital heart anomaly with right-to-left shunt, but the nasogastric tube placement without issues makes this less likely compared to NRDS.

- Given the symptoms of respiratory distress and the mother's history of gestational diabetes (which increases risk for NRDS), NRDS is the most likely diagnosis.

- Tracheoesophageal fistula would likely present with feeding difficulties and aspiration, which were not mentioned.

- Pneumonia is less likely without fever and other infection-related symptoms.

- Congenital heart anomaly with right-to-left shunt is possible but less likely without more specific symptoms.

- NRDS is the most likely diagnosis given the respiratory symptoms and the mother's history of gestational diabetes.

- The most likely diagnosis is Neonatal Respiratory Distress Syndrome (NRDS).

- The symptoms of respiratory distress, tachypnea, and the mother's history of gestational diabetes all point to NRDS.

- Tracheoesophageal fistula, pneumonia, and congenital heart anomaly with right-to-left shunt are less likely given the symptoms and the absence of other signs.

- NRDS is the most likely diagnosis.

</think><answer>

A. Neonatal respiratory distress syndrome (NRDS)

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